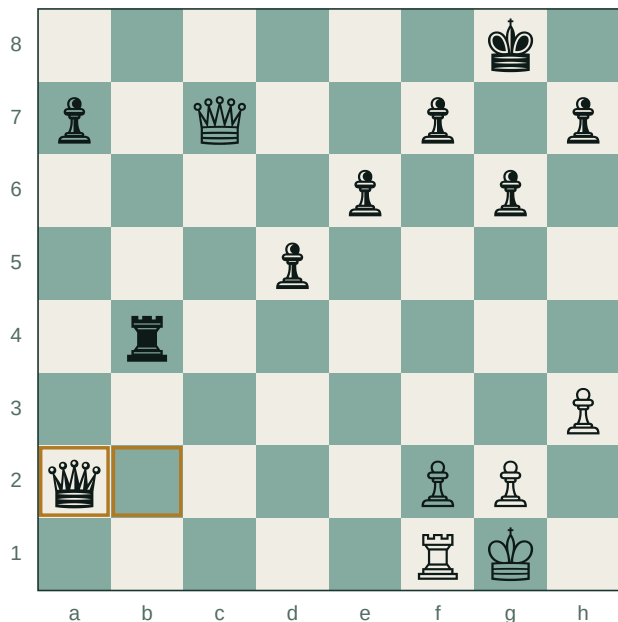


# Forks and double attacks: White, move 27

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 26...Qxa2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**27. Qc8+ Kg7 28. Qc3+ d4 29. Qxb4**

**27.Qc8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **27...Kg7**.

**28.Qc3+** Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. From c3 it attacks king on g7 and rook on b4. Recorded reply: **28...d4**.

**29.Qxb4** The queen captures the rook on b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b4 and queen on a2. Check for tactical protection.